

backed securities” (which contributed to Wall Street’s collapse), complicated derivatives (which kept regulators baffled), or high-tech start-ups (which sometimes generate ideas rather than products), they can get themselves in trouble. Skip them unless you know these products inside and out. Also, understand the tax implications of all your investments. Yes, you get a tax credit when you invest in a traditional IRA, but you pay taxes when you withdraw money from it, a detail many people leave out when they calculate their future income. That’s why a good financial advisor is key to growing your wealth. A broker might help you pick your financial products, but an advisor will help you navigate the financial terrain.

4. **Don’t be greedy.** It’s called “B&H”—buy and hold. That means you don’t want to buy and sell stocks with every single up and down of the market—a paranoid and insecure way to invest, and one that rarely leads to great success. Plus, it’ll make you crazy, unless you’re an experienced day trader.
5. **Don’t believe the hype.** Stock tips are often a bunch of hokum designed to sell a product. It’s all marketing. Trust your gut, and your money manager. Data can be interpreted a lot of ways, and a good broker knows how to understand the numbers. Go back to your mother’s advice: If it’s too good to be true, it is.